the form of materials prepared outside the country, often repurposed but sometimes designed explicitly to address Myanmar. To be clear: my argument is not a relative comparison between the importance of arguments situated outside and inside the country. It would be possible, for example, to construct a narrative of Muslim threat that is spatially confined to Myanmar; Muslims could be constructed as threats and illustrated as such by drawing on claims about the content of the religion and examples of alleged misdeeds by only Myanmar Muslims. Certainly, the claim is not that anti-Muslim narratives in Myanmar exist only because they also exist in the US and elsewhere. This would be to both treat events in Myanmar as primarily derivative, and to ignore other times when Muslims in Myanmar have suffered violence.

And yet, we cannot simply dismiss the relationships between narratives in Myanmar and elsewhere, where discourses and references to events inside and outside the country are used as materials to reinforce universal claims about Islamic threat. Strands of argument that are spatially outside Myanmar are what enable the construction of a threat that is perceived to be both inside Myanmar and surrounding it. This narrative presents Islam as a threat that is understood to be global and for which Muslims in Myanmar are the vanguard. In this sense, the interrelationship between narratives about Islam inside and outside Myanmar is a necessary condition for this understanding of threat, though it is not necessarily sufficient. Daw Aung San Suu Kyi has been explicit about the global nature of this perception: "Fear is not just on the side of the Muslims, but on the side of the Buddhists as well," she explained to the BBC in October 2013. "There's a perception that Muslim power, global Muslim power, is very great" (BBC 2013). Non-Burmese observers pilloried her for this interview (Blair 2013),[23] but her placement of domestic fears within a global context was descriptively accurate. The narrative is not that there is anything particularly threatening about Muslims in Myanmar, but instead that Muslims in Myanmar are *no less* threatening than Muslims *anywhere*.

Situating this sense of threat globally helps to explain how an overwhelming demographic majority that controls the state can fear a domestically marginalized minority. But, again, we must not treat the production of narratives about Islam in Myanmar as exclusively derivative: experiences during colonialism, in which large-scale immigration occurred from elsewhere in then-British India, and when Rangoon appeared to be more an Indian city than Burmese, also provide ample material for